

Juan P. Aparicio

Applied Economist and Data Scientist | Political Economy of Conflict | Research Reproducibility

PhD economist working on the political economy of conflict and media, research reproducibility, and applied data science.

Methods: applied microeconomics, causal inference, time-series and demand forecasting, survey data analysis, replication audits, human-AI evaluation.

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Google Scholar: <https://scholar.google.com/citations?user=ap4duGUAAAAJ&hl=en>

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

- Research Scientist (Postdoctoral Researcher), Institute for Replication, Ottawa, Canada | 2024-present. Organizes replication games and AI Games projects on human-AI interaction and research productivity; has led papers involving more than 700 replicators and contributed to projects involving more than 2,000 replicators, including work published in Nature, PNAS, Psychological Science, and Nature Human Behaviour.
- Visiting positions: Centre for the Study of Existential Risk, University of Cambridge | May 2026; Victoria University of Wellington | December 2025.
- Fellow, CivicScience | 2024-present. Ongoing advisory role on survey-based demand forecasting.
- Senior Economist & Senior Data Scientist, CivicScience, Pittsburgh, USA | 2022-2024. Developed demand-forecasting applications using CivicScience's real-time survey data and tested them with clients including McDonald's, Target, and Bank of America. The forecasting work later became a product line.
- Postdoctoral Researcher & Senior Consultant, Universidad EAFIT, Medellín, Colombia | 2022-2023. Led EAFIT's consulting work with the Federación Nacional de Departamentos on liquor and cigarette smuggling in Colombia, resulting in the policy report listed below.

EDUCATION

- Ph.D. in Economics, University of Western Australia | 2023. Dean's list honorable mention.
- M.Sc. in Economics, Université catholique de Louvain | 2018.
- B.S. in Economics, Universidad EAFIT | 2016. Graduated with honors.

PEER-REVIEWED ARTICLES

- AI-assisted teams outperform AI-led teams but not human-only teams in assessing research reproducibility in quantitative social science. Large-scale collaboration (272 authors; Brodeur, Valenta, Marcoci, Aparicio, et al.). **Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences**, 123(22), e2524747123, 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1073/pnas.2524747123>. Author contributions (J.P.A.): designed research, performed research, organized replication games, co-wrote the paper.
- Captivating news: Media attention and FARC kidnappings. With Michael Jetter. **Journal of Economic Behavior & Organization**, 202, 69-81, 2022. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1016/j.jebo.2022.07.029>.
- Demanda de internet: el sector mayorista de telecomunicaciones colombiano (Internet Demand: The Colombian Wholesale Telecommunications Sector). With John J. García Rendón. **Revista de Economía del Rosario**, 19(2), 2016. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.12804/revistas.urosario.edu.co/economia/a.5624>.

WORKING PAPERS

- Peacefully Demobilizing Rebels: Identity, Emotional Cues, and the FARC. With Michael Jetter and Christopher Parsons. **IZA Discussion Paper No. 16054**, 2023. Under review at the European Economic Review.
<https://www.iza.org/en/publications/dp/16054/peacefully-demobilizing-rebels-identity-emotional-cues-and-the-farc>.

- The Wrong Snowball: Reintegration Signals and Demobilization in Colombia. With Verónica Abril. Working paper.
- You Speak, We Shoot: On the Unintended Consequences of Community Radios on Colombia's Violent Conflict. With Gustavo Canavire-Bacarreza and Eric Neumayer. Working paper; under review at the Journal of Peace Research.

JOURNAL COMMENTS AND REPLICATIONS

- Comment on "Telementoring and Homeschooling during School Closures: A Randomized Experiment in Rural Bangladesh" by Hassan et al. With Nikolai Cook, Derek Mikola, Ole Rogeberg, David Valenta, Michael Wiebe, Carl Bonander, and Abel Brodeur. **The Economic Journal**, 2026. DOI: <https://doi.org/10.1093/ej/ueag040>.
- A Comment on "Delivering Remote Learning Using a Low-Tech Solution: Evidence from a Randomized Controlled Trial in Bangladesh". With Lenka Fiala, Jack Fitzgerald, Essi Kujansuu, Derek Mikola, David Valenta, Michael Wiebe, Matthew D. Webb, and Abel Brodeur. **I4R Discussion Paper Series**, 2025. <https://ideas.repec.org/p/zbw/i4rdps/241.html>.

BOOKS AND POLICY REPORTS

- Estrategias anticontrabando y crimen organizado. EAFIT & Federación Nacional de Departamentos, 2023. Consulting engagement led by Juan P. Aparicio. <https://www.programaanticontrabando.com.co/pdfs/Estrategias%20anticontrabando%20y%20crimen%20organizado.pdf>.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Violence and Migration: Analyzing the Mujahideen. With Christopher Parsons.
- Polarization in Democratic Elections: Insights from an Enhanced Hotelling's Model.

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- Research on Research initiative, I4R (Co-investigator): USD 187,210, 2025.
- Sloan Foundation, I4R (Co-investigator): USD 134,784, 2025.
- University of Western Australia: Dean's list, Postgraduate Award, Top Up Scholarship.
- Other awards: Laureate Thesis (Universidad EAFIT); RTP Scholarship (Australian Government); Beca ICETEX.

TEACHING

- Advanced Topics in Econometrics, Universidad EAFIT | 2025.
- Introduction to Microeconomics, Universidad EIA | 2024.
- Introduction to the Colombian Economy, Universidad EIA | 2023.
- Intermediate Macroeconomics, Universidad EIA | 2023.
- Microeconomics Seminar, Universidad EAFIT | 2021-2023. Student evaluation: 4.8/5.
- Growth and Development, Universidad EAFIT | 2022. Student evaluation: 4.7/5.

SUPERVISION AND SERVICE

- Supervised or mentored students at Louvain School of Economics, Universidad EIA, and Universidad EAFIT.
- Referee service: Proceedings of the National Academy of Sciences Nexus, Journal of Productivity Analysis, Sports Economics Review, Journal of the Operational Research Society, Migration Studies, Revista de Economía del Rosario.
- Pro bono consulting for International Justice Mission on violence against women and children in Colombia.

SKILLS

- Methods: applied microeconomics, causal inference (difference-in-differences, instrumental variables, event studies), randomized and natural experiments, time-series and demand forecasting, replication audits, survey data analysis, human-AI evaluation.
- Software: R, Python, SQL, Stata, Git/GitHub, LaTeX, Excel.
- Languages: Spanish native; English C1; French and Portuguese basic reading comprehension with limited speaking proficiency.